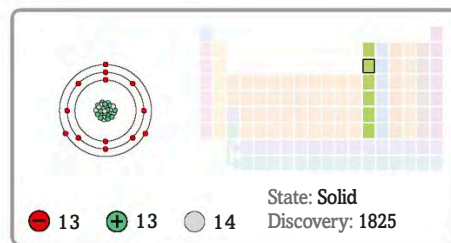
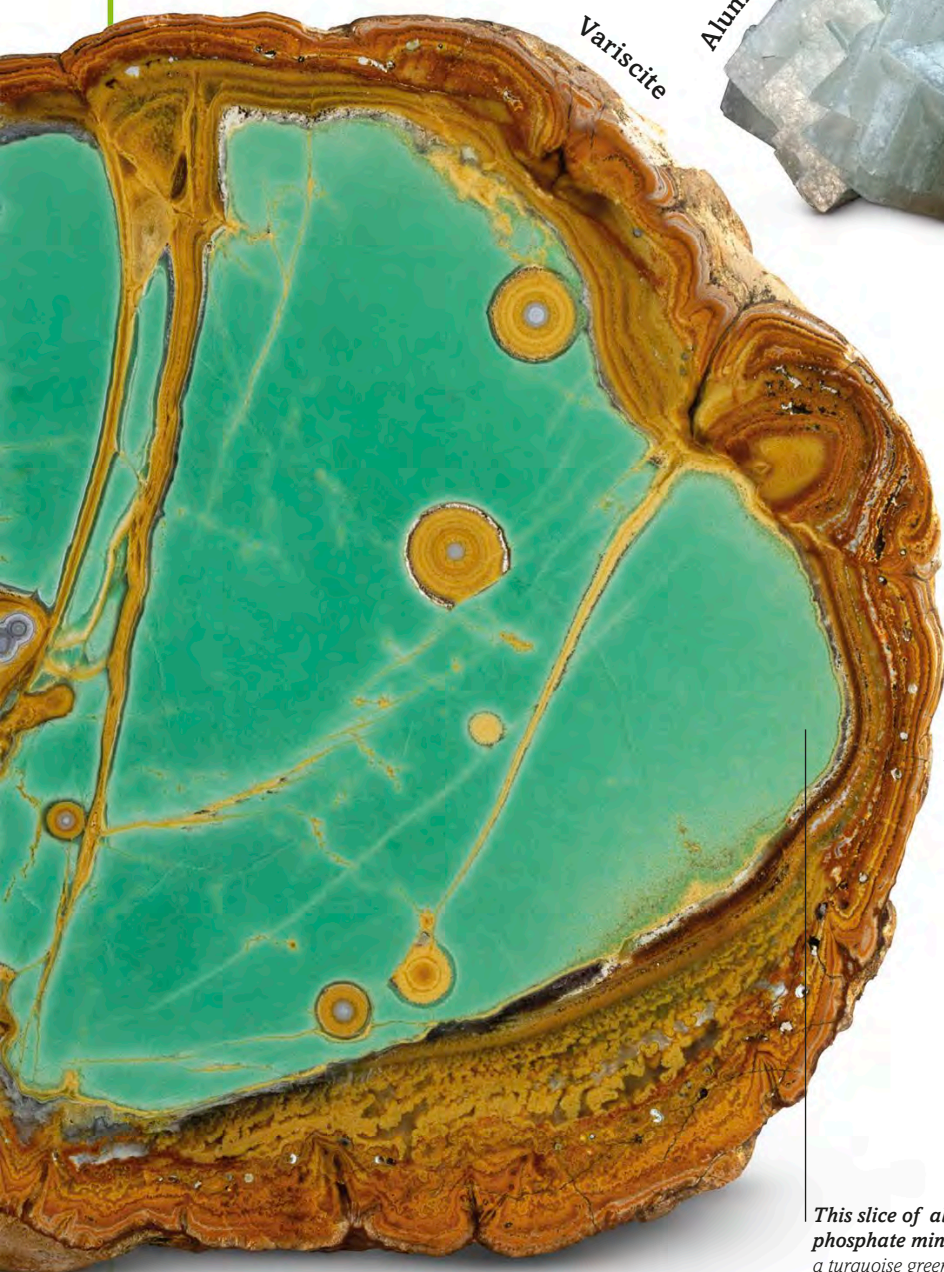


13
Al

Aluminium



Forms



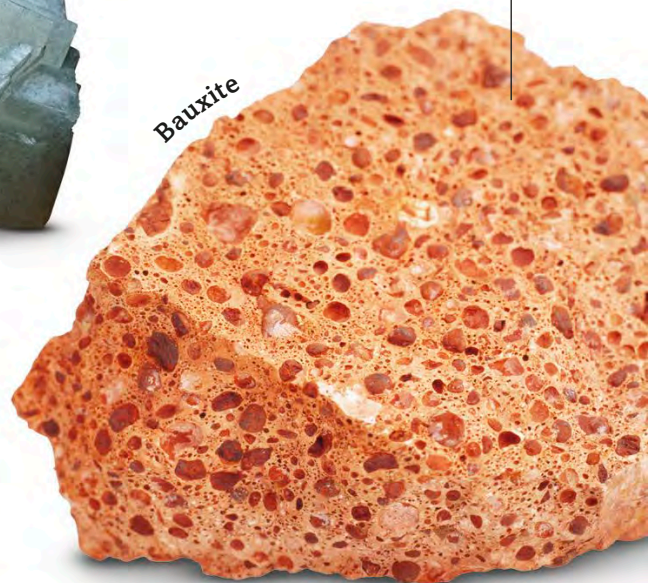
Variscite



Alum crystal

This crystal contains aluminium and sulfur compounds.

This aluminium ore is the world's main source of the element.



Bauxite

Pellets of pure aluminium refined in a laboratory



Reflective surface

This slice of aluminium phosphate mineral has a turquoise green colour.

Although aluminium is the most common metal in Earth's rocks, scientists did not discover it until the early 1800s. Even then, it took a further 80 years for scientists to work out how to use the ore **bauxite** to extract large amounts of **pure aluminium**. It can

also be found in other minerals, including **variscite**. Today, aluminium is often recycled because producing it anew requires 15 times more energy. The metal makes a strong, shiny **foil** when rolled flat, and is useful for storing foods. A **fire protection suit** made from